PANELTEC PTY LTD

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ABN: 12 128 689 412

SWMS-45

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	**Supervisor/Foreman**	**Date:**	
High Risk Construction Work:	**STABILISER - SAFE OPERATION**	**Project:**	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025 *SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier* **Signature:**		**Location:**	

Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"

John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023		31/08/2025 – V12.0
Name	**Position**	☎	**Signature**	**Date**

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability L *Likely*	M *Moderate*	U Unlikely
H (1) *(High level of harm)*	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) *(High)*	1	1	2
M (2) *(Medium level of harm)*	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) *(Medium)*	1	2	3
L (3) *(Low level of harm)*	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) *(Low)*	2	3	3

Level	Likelihood / Probability
Likely	Could happen frequently
Moderate	Could happen occasionally
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 **Eliminate the hazard**
Level 2 **Substitute the hazard with something safer.**
Level 3 **Isolate the hazard from people.** **Reduce the risks through engineering controls.**
Level 4 **Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.**
Level 5 **Use personal protective equipment**
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in place
Training	To prevent injuries or illness to workers	**1**	1. Machinery operators will have the necessary current licence or competency certificate for the equipment they will operate. 2. Heed and obey warning signs. 3. Do not operate or work on this machine unless you have read and understand the instructions and warnings in the Operation and Maintenance Manual. 4. Failure to follow the instructions or heed the warnings could result in injury or death. 5. All persons operating equipment and working on site will have a current construction induction card.	Supervisor All	**2**
Arriving on site	Entry unsafe or unauthorised areas	**1**	1. Report to site office for site induction if required. 2. Risk assessment of site conditions and Site specific induction & toolbox meeting to be conducted. 3. Consider all environmental protection issues and the impact caused by entry to site.	All Supervisor	**2**
Set out work area	Struck by road or construction plant.	**1**	1. Barricade area off or sign appropriately to restrict access and minimise plant working area as per traffic management plan. 2. All site personnel to wear PPE as per site induction. 3. All vehicles and equipment to have operational flashing lights and reversing beepers. 4. UHF radios available where required.	Supervisor All Operator	**2**
	Persons falling or tripping over on site.	**2**	1. Maintain good housekeeping. 2. Barricade off unsafe areas. 3. Clearly mark protruding objects using paint, caps or hazard tape.	All Supervisor Supervisor	**3**
	Dust entering eyes	**2**	1. Suppress dust using water truck where applicable. 2. Eye protection to be worn at all times.	Supervisor All	**3**

Steps in Activity	**Potential Hazards**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class After Controls in place**
Pre Start Check	Unsafe equipment Potential for accident	**1**	1. Pre start checklist forms filled out & defects documented, supervisor notified of any safety hazards or defects. 2. Make sure that all protective guards and all covers are secured in place on the equipment. 3. Make sure that the machine horn, the backup alarm and all other warning devices are working properly. 4. Refer to Operation and Maintenance Manual, “Daily Inspection” before you operate the machine.	Operator	**2**
Access/egress on plant	Falls	**2**	1. Mount the machine and dismount the machine only at locations that have steps and/or handholds. 2. Before you mount the machine, clean the steps and the handholds. Inspect the steps and handholds. Make all necessary repairs. 3. Face the machine whenever you get on the machine and whenever you get off the machine. 4. Always maintain 3 point of contact with the steps and with the handholds when climbing up and down from stabilizer.	Operator	**3**
Before operation of stabiliser	Striking personnel and other plant. Plant roll over. Electrocution	**1**	1. Hold toolbox meeting to discuss site hazards. 2. Make sure you are aware of any potentially low overhead wires and not these on toolbox meeting form and appoint spotter if required. 3. Use Dial Before You Dig to highlight if underground services will be a hazard. 4. Clear all personnel from the machine - maintain a minimum distance of 10 m (33ft). 5. Reflective safety vests to be worn at all times. Wear a hard hat, protective glasses, and other protective equipment, as required. Do not wear loose clothing or jewelry that can snag on controls or on other parts of the equipment. 6. Clear all obstacles that are in the path of the machine. 7. Beware of hazards such as wires, ditches, etc. 8. Know the appropriate work site hand signals and the personnel that are authorized to give the hand signals. 9. Accept hand signals from one person only.	Supervisor Operator All	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in place
Stabiliser operation	Striking personnel and other plant. Plant roll over. Electrocution	**1**	1. Only competent operators to operate the stabiliser. 2. Stabiliser to have operational flashing light and reversing beeper. 3. The operator must satisfy himself that no one will be endangered before moving the machine. 4. Never operate a stabiliser at speeds that are unsafe. 5. Only operate the machine while you are in a seat. 6. The seat belt must be fastened while you operate the machine. 7. Only operate the controls while the engine is running. 8. While you operate the machine slowly in an open area, check for proper operation of all controls and all protective devices. 9. Do not allow riders on the machine unless the machine has an additional seat. 10. Note any needed repairs during machine operation. 11. Report any needed repairs. 12. Lower the rotor. 13. Slowly propel the machine when you start a cut. This operation prevents the machine from riding up on the rotor and lunging backward. This operation also prevents excessive bouncing. 14. Do not allow anyone to stand or walk behind the machine while the machine is in operation. 15. The machine may lunge backward if the rotor hits an obstruction. 16. Carry attachments approximately 40 cm (15 inches) above ground level. 17. Do not go close to the edge of a cliff, an excavation, or an overhang. 18. If the machine begins to sideslip downward on a grade, immediately remove the load and turn the machine downhill. 19. Avoid any conditions that can lead to tipping the machine.	Supervisor Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in place
			20. The machine can tip when you work on hills, on banks and on slopes. Also, the machine can tip when you cross ditches, ridges or other unexpected obstructions. 21. Avoid operating the machine across the slope. 22. When possible, operate the machine up the slopes and down the slopes. 23. Maintain control of the machine at all times. 24. Do not overload the machine beyond the machine capacity. 25. Be sure that the hitches and the towing devices are adequate. 26. Only connect the trailing equipment to a drawbar or to a hitch. 27. Know the width of your equipment in order to maintain proper clearance when you operate the equipment near fences or near boundary obstacles. 28. Be aware of high voltage power lines and power cables that are buried. If the machine comes in contact with these hazards, serious injury or death may occur from electrocution.		
	Cutter Hazard and Rotor Movement Hazard, Stay Back	**1**	1. Rotor movement can cause injury or death. Stay clear of the rotor when the engine is running. 2. Shut off the engine before performing any service on the rotor or its housing.	Operator	**2**
	Flying Debris Hazard,	**1**	1. Flying debris may cause serious personal injury or death. Maintain a minimum distance of 10 m (33ft)	Operator	**2**
	Crush Hazard	**1**	1. Do not operate this machine if the rotor service panel door is not closed and secured.	Operator	**2**
Stabiliser shut down	Personnel struck by rolling plant Explosion Crushing	**1**	1. Assess parking area as to site vision for other works in the area. 2. Park in a non operating area. 3. Park away from deep excavations and trenches. 4. Never leave the Stabiliser unattended with the engine running. Park the machine on a level surface.	Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in place
			5. If you must park the machine on a grade, you must block the machine. 6. Move the propel lever to the NEUTRAL position in order to stop the machine. 7. Place all controls in the NEUTRAL position. 8. Engage the parking brake by pushing the parking brake control to the ON position. The parking brake control will light. 9. Lower the rotor and the hood until the rotor rests on the ground. 10. Stop the engine. 11. Turn the engine start switch to the OFF position and remove the key. 12. Turn the battery disconnect switch to the OFF position.		
Maintenance Refueling	Personal injury Fire/explosion Burns Crush hazard	**1**	1. Do not operate or perform any lubrication, maintenance or repair on this product, until you have read and understood the operation, lubrication, maintenance and repair information. 2. Attach a “Do Not Operate” warning tag or a similar warning tag to the start switch or to the controls before you service the equipment or before you repair the equipment and take out the key . 3. Support the equipment properly before you perform any work or maintenance beneath that equipment. 4. Do not depend on the hydraulic cylinders to hold up the equipment. Equipment can fall if a control is moved, or if a hydraulic line breaks. 5. Do not work beneath the cab of the machine unless the cab is properly supported. 6. Do not leave the engine running while making adjustments or repairs unless specifically recommended and a safe management plan is in place and a second person is in attendance. 7. Never refuel when the engine is running.	Operator Maintenance person	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in place
			8. Do not smoke while filling the fuel tank or servicing the fuel system. 9. Do not oil, grease, check for faulty wiring or loose connections or adjust any part of the Stabiliser while it is in motion. 10. Refer to Operation and Maintenance Manual for the procedure for placing the equipment in the servicing position. 11. Do not touch any part of an operating engine. 12. Allow the engine to cool before any maintenance.		

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	**Hazard**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class after Controls in place**
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	**1**	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	**2**
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	**2**	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	**3**
Bitumen/Prime	During heavy rain, recently placed prime or bitumen could emulsify and wash into surrounding waterways.	**1**	1. Plan prime or bitumen operation so that it is conducted during fine weather. 2. Have material available to clean up a spill if it occurs and dispose of contaminated material accordingly. 3. Protect storm drains during and after application to prevent pollution - have spill clean-up materials available.	Supervisor All	**2**
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	**2**	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	**3**
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	**2**	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	**3**
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	**1**	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client’s representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	**2**

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	**1**	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	**2**
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	**2**	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	**3**
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	**1**	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	**2**
Visual Impact **Litter and Amenities** **Waste Management**	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	**2**	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste asphalt will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	**3**

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.			
• All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
• If required Client Site Induction • Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	• Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	• Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	• Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
• First Aid certificate training	• Manual Handling training	• Fire Extinguisher training	• Fatigue Management Training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

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WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.